

The Japanese house has always understood the threshold. The *engawa* — the wooden veranda that runs along the edge of a room, neither fully inside nor fully out — is the architecture of the in-between, a place to sit with the garden a step away and the shade behind you. Few of us have one. All of us have a door.

So the summer move is to treat one opening as the centre of the room. Pull the table or the two chairs toward it. Hang a sheer linen panel that moves in the draught and softens the glare

without closing the view. Let the floor read continuously to the threshold — roll the heavy rug away and leave the bare boards running out to the light. The room is no longer a box with a window; it is a porch with a roof.

Then subtract for the heat. One pale cloth, not a layered nest. A jug of water and a single stem, not a tablescape. The cool of the room is its emptiness and its draught — the *ma* and the open door doing together what no fan does alone.



Calm & Oak

